

3.6 Opera

The Opera browser's tagline, 'Your Web Everywhere', symbolises the fact that this is the only browser in the world that can run on the most number of platforms, from the usual Windows, Linux and Mac OS platforms to mobile phones, the Wii gaming console and the Nintendo DS. Though primarily a desktop browser, Opera has a dominant market share on mobile phones.

Opera Software claims that their browser is "the fastest browser on Earth." This fact is reconfirmed in speed tests run by several independent browser reviewers with the best part of the browser being its JavaScript execution, which performed twice as fast as other browsers.

3.6.2 Features

In spite of the browser not supporting extensions like FF, there are many innovative features built into Opera and extension developers of the FF browser copy quite a few of its features. Opera comes with a variety of in-built features like an e-mail client, an RSS feed reader, a download manager, a BitTorrent client, phishing protection, tabbed browsing, a popup blocker, an ad blocker, mouse gestures, a voice recognition software and the ability to support widgets, which are small programs that run on top of a program or Web page and provide information to the user. One of the newest features of Opera is Speed Dial, which allows you to add up to nine links to a page which is displayed when a new tab is opened. Opera also has a history of being one of the most standards-compliant browsers on the Web.

When you use the browser for the first time, its interface needs some getting used to, but once you have passed that hurdle, you realise that the browser has the most flexible toolbar layout.

3.6.3 Tips And Tricks

There are quite a few settings in the browser that you can tinker with to make it work better.

You can provide nicknames for your most visited Web pages so that you can open them quickly from the address bar. To do so,